

August

18



1805

Taking to the skies

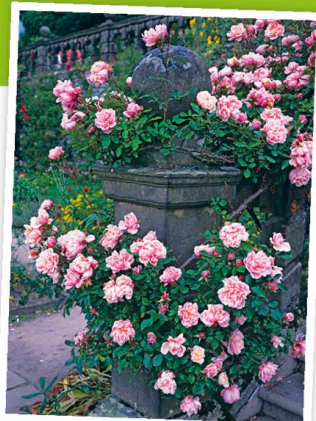
French aviator Sophie Blanchard began her career as the first female professional hot-air balloonist when she flew by herself for the first time, over Toulouse, France.

Also on this day

1590 On returning to Roanoke, USA, colonist John White discovered that everyone in the English settlement had mysteriously disappeared.

2005 A massive power outage on the Indonesian islands of Java and Bali left nearly 120 million people in darkness.

2019 A memorial service was held for the Okjökull glacier in Iceland, after it melted away following the country's warmest summer on record.



1931

New rose

Henry Bosenberg of New Jersey, USA, was granted the first plant patent for the new variety

of rose he had created, called New Dawn. This plant produces silvery pink roses that bloom throughout the year.

Born this day

1911 **Amelia Boynton Robinson**, Black American civil rights activist. She led three protest marches from Selma, Alabama, USA.

1988 **Kwon Ji-yong**, South Korean rapper and producer. Known by his stage name G-Dragon, he found fame with the band Big Bang, before releasing his first solo album in 2009.

1920 Last tug of the rope

Tug-of-war was played as an Olympic sport for the last time at the Antwerp Olympics in Belgium, with Great Britain winning against the Netherlands.

